

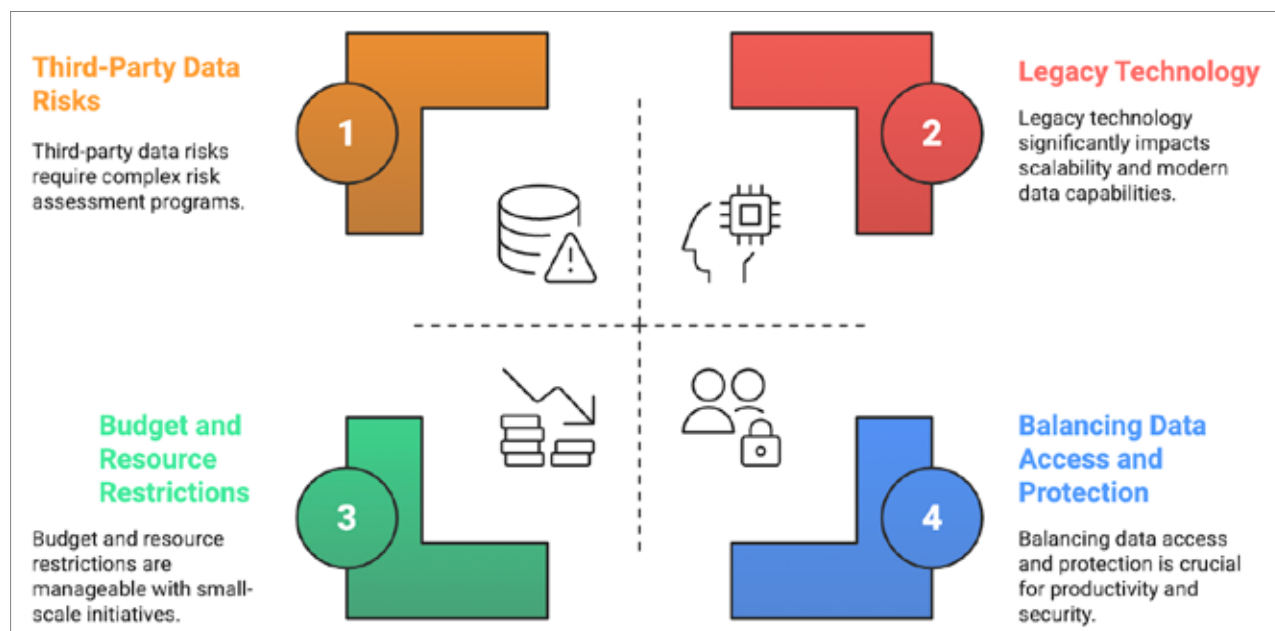


Figure 3: Common challenges

develop a shared understanding about the value of data. Developing a data culture is not simply about hiring or developing a data analyst; it's not even about empowering a data team. It involves working with teams, educating leadership on data-related topics, and working to align the whole organisation to a common set of goals around data. Everyone, from the marketing team to the CEO, must consider data a part of their daily responsibilities.

Step 4: Address monitoring and improvement continuously: Being great with data is not a one-time task. There needs to be consistent effort. Organise frequent auditing, regularly monitor KPIs and do compliance reporting, and ensure in-trust data practices that evolve with changes in business law and regulatory requirements. Remember the ideal is not perfection – it is continuous improvement!

Common challenges and how to tackle them

Even when using best practices, businesses often face a few challenges when managing and securing data. The table above lists some of the most common challenges and how to

Challenge	Why it's a problem	How to tackle it
Legacy technology	Outdated technology creates limitations with scalability and often doesn't allow for modern data capabilities.	Modernise gradually with hybrid environments, APIs, and new data integration tools.
Finding the balance between data access and data protection	Limiting access too much may impact productivity; too much access may lead to security problems	Place a role-based access control and data classification framework across the data landscape.
Budget and resource restrictions	Data initiatives can be costly and require specific knowledge and just-in-time resources.	Build on high impact, small scale initiatives and leverage the cloud or open source.
Third-party data risks	Third-party vendors can put your systems and compliance at risk.	Conduct ongoing audits, apply rigorous contractual vendor agreements, and consider risk assessment programs.

address them.

Data is no longer just a byproduct of business — it is the way of doing business. Unified data management, built-in security, and a culture of accountability can convert data into

true business value. The companies that will lead are the ones that do not look at data as merely a function of IT but as a way to accelerate growth. The future belongs to those who act now and use data to their advantage. **END** 🐧

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